

Audio & Music Direction Brief

Dear Friend

An Interactive Tablet-Based Story

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Version: 1.1



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1. Project Overview

Dear Friend is a short poetic tablet-based story created for an in-situ exhibition on the theme of care at the Geneva Municipal Library.

The story is experienced from a first-person perspective.

Camille, a student participating in a "rent-a-student" university program, visits Sylvia, an elderly woman seeking help with her computer. While freeing up storage space and sorting through old files, Camille gradually discovers fragments of Sylvia's past and present life. As the two grow closer, Camille is drawn into a difficult decision : whether to delete a digital trace of a recently deceased friend or preserve it.

Through this intimate encounter, *Dear Friend* explores care, memory, and grief.

Project Type

Intimate, poetic, atmospheric, human.

Estimated Experience Time

3–5 minutes

Target Audience

General public (recommended age : 12+)

2. Creative Vision

The music and sound design should support Camille's and Sylvia's emotions in a subtle, non-dramatic way.

The overall experience should feel warm, intimate, and slightly dreamlike. We imagine a space suspended between memory and reality, evoking a feeling close to a gentle purgatory.

Players should feel as though they are uncovering personal stories rather than completing tasks or achieving goals. The role of the audio is to support immersion, empathy, and discovery without overwhelming the experience.

Emotional Journey

Beginning

- Neutral
- Indifferent
- Slightly bored

Middle

- Curiosity
- Discovery
- Growing emotional connection

End

- Reflection
- Acceptance
- Emotional resolution

Music should never dominate the experience. It should feel like it naturally belongs to the environment.

3. Music Direction

Style

Ambient / cinematic hybrid with organic and electronic textures.

References

- [Peak](#) (especially from 1:40 onward)
- [Kankyō Ongaku](#) / Environmental Music
- Satoshi Ashikawa
- Additional references to be discussed

Avoid

- Heavy percussion
- Trailer-style music
- Aggressive electronic sounds
- Constant melodies
- Excessive emotional manipulation

Silence is as important as music. The score should leave space for the emotional weight of the story and the spoken dialogue.

4. Interaction Audio & Sound Design Notes

The project includes small interactive audio cues such as mouse clicks, UI feedback, hover sounds, and window interactions.

These sounds should:

- Feel integrated with the overall sound world
- Support the tactile feeling of interaction
- Be subtle and non-intrusive
- Match the emotional tone of the scene
- Avoid stereotypical "digital UI" sounds

The composer/sound designer is encouraged to experiment creatively with these sounds. They do not need to be strictly realistic. Abstract, musical, or stylized interpretations are welcome as long as they support usability and immersion.

5. Audio Deliverables

Atmospheres

Exterior Ambience

- Birds
- Airplanes
- Distant construction site sounds

Sylvia's Presence

- Coughing
- Moving objects
- Turning book pages
- Other subtle signs of presence

Event Sounds

- Camera zoom in / zoom out
- Computer fan reacting to memory storage being cleaned
- Birds passing by the window
- Transitions between days

UI & Interaction Sounds

- Password entry (keyboard)
- Mouse clicks
- Hover feedback
- Delete file / move to trash
- Open file
- Close window
- Notifications

Music

The composer is invited to propose a musical structure adapted to the experience and its emotional progression.

6. Audio Integration & Collaboration

The project is developed in Unity.

At this stage, we are open to discussing the scope of the composer's involvement. Depending on interest and availability, this could include:

- Music composition
- Sound design
- Audio mixing
- Audio implementation in Unity
- Creative direction for the overall audio experience

We would be interested in hearing your preferred way of working and discussing which aspects of the audio pipeline you would like to contribute to.

The current list of audio assets and interactions should therefore be considered indicative rather than prescriptive.

7. Technical Requirements

- WAV
- 48 kHz
- 24-bit

When applicable:

- Seamless loops
- Clearly named files
- Separate stems and layers

8. Production Notes

The project values atmosphere, emotional subtlety, and sonic cohesion.

Music and sound design should feel like part of the same world rather than separate systems.

Creative proposals are welcome.

Dialogues

Voice recordings are currently in production and may not be available during the first composition phase. Temporary text and prototype timing should be considered indicative rather than final. The music should remain flexible enough to accommodate future dialogue integration.

9. Schedule

June 26 – July 1, 2026

- Recording Sylvia's voice

Until July 1, 2026

- Writing additional chapter(s)

July 1, 2026

- Composer brief finalized

July – August 2026

- Feature development (levels, interactions, audio integration, etc.)

From August 31, 2026

- UI polishing and fixes

From September 14, 2026

- Debugging with Raphaël Muñoz

October 1, 2026 (tentative)

- Final project delivery

October 10, 2026

- Exhibition opening

10. Project Demo

- Video walkthrough: [[Link](#)]
 - Playable browser build: [[Link](#)]
 - GitHub repository and development archive: [[Link](#)]
 - Project presentation PDF: [[Link](#)]
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11. Credits

Team

[Alireza Asnavandi](#), Visual Design, 2D Art & 3D Art, Shader Development & Lighting

Ariadne Melissargos, Asset Creation, Interaction Design & Programming, Narrative Development

Julia Sangnakkara, Animation, Cinematography Bible, Narrative Development, Sound Integration

Teachers

[Douglas Edric Stanley](#), Project Lead, Master Media Design, HEAD – Geneva

[Sabrina Calvo](#), TransFeminist, Science Fiction & Games Writer, Textile Artist

[Pierre Rossel](#), Master Media Design, HEAD – Geneva

[Andreia Rodrigues](#), Assistante, Master Media Design, HEAD – Geneva

Raphaël Muñoz, Media Designer, co-founder of [Aprobado Studio](#) – Geneva

Partner

[Cassandra Poirier-Simon](#) (email), [Service des bibliothèques municipales, Genève](#)